IGI
SCHOOL OF GEMOLOGY

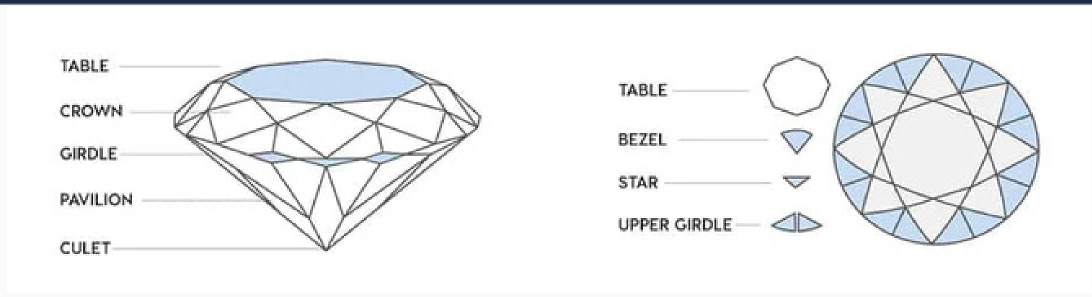
YOUR DIAMOND
KNOWLEDGE CARD

Retail Excellence Program

Quick Reference Guide for Retail Sales Associates

C1	C2	C3	C4	C5
CUT	COLOR	CLARITY	CARAT	CERT
The Magic	The Grade	The Invisible	The Size	Secret Weapon

This guide empowers associates with the knowledge, language, and confidence to sell effectively in every customer interaction.



THE 5Cs AT A GLANCE — KNOW IT. USE IT. SELL WITH CONFIDENCE.

C1
CUT
TheMagic

Quality of craftsmanship — angles, proportions & polish that control light return & brilliance.
Scale: Excellent → Very Good → Good → Fair → Poor

"The cut is what makes it sparkle."

C2
COLOR
The Grade

Absence of color in a white diamond. D (completely colorless, rarest) to Z (visibly yellow tint).
Scale: D–F Colorless | G–J. Near Colorless | K–M. SlightlyTinted | N–Z Tinted

"This is graded D — the purest color possible."

C3
CLARITY
Invisible

Presence or absence of internal inclusions & surface blemishes under 10x magnification.
Scale: FL/IF → VVS1/VVS2 → VS1/VS2 → SI1/SI2 → I1/I2/I3

"Completely eye-clean — only visible under a microscope."

C4
CARAT
Size Story

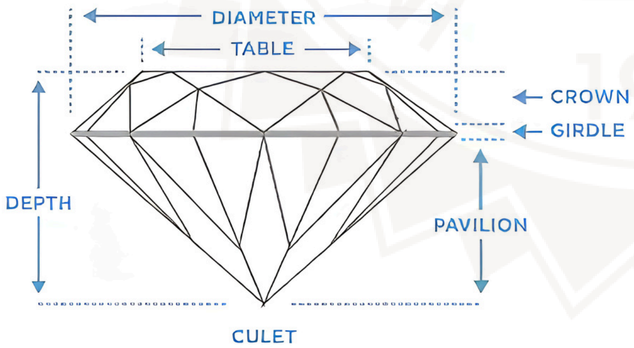
Unit of weight. 1 carat = 0.2 grams = 100 cents. LGDs give dramatically MORE carat per rupee.
Scale:1carat = 0.2g | 1carat = 100 points | 1carat = 100cents | 1carat =4 grains

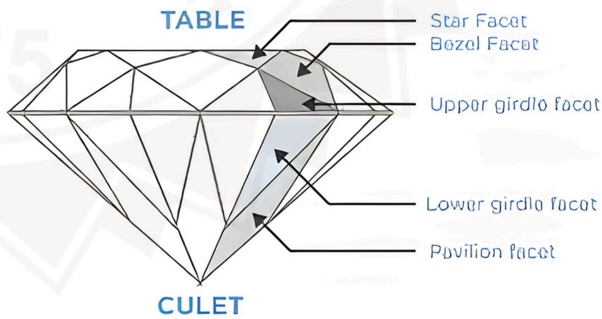
"Same carat as a natural — at a fraction of the price."

C5
CERTIFICATE.
Secret Weapon

The IGI grading report — an independent scientific assessment of every parameter of your diamond.
Scale:ReportNo. | Shape | Color | Clarity | Carat | CutGrade | Fluorescence | QR Code

"Before I tell you anything — let me show you the certificate."






Round Brilliant


Princess

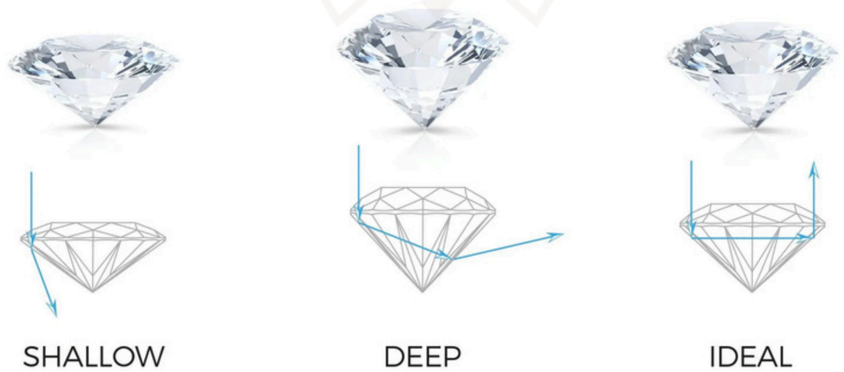

Marquise


Heart


Cushion

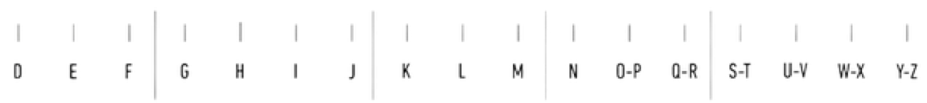
C1 — CUT GRADES

IDEAL / EXCELLENT	★★★★★	Maximum light return. Every facet perfectly aligned. Always recommend first.
VERY GOOD	★★★★☆	Excellent brilliance. Very slight deviation from ideal proportions. Great value.
GOOD	★★★☆☆	Good brightness. Noticeable deviation from ideal. Budget option for melee stones.
FAIR	★★☆☆☆	Light leakage visible. Noticeably less sparkle. Avoid for solitaires.
POOR	★☆☆☆☆	Significant light loss. Dull appearance. Not recommended for any product.



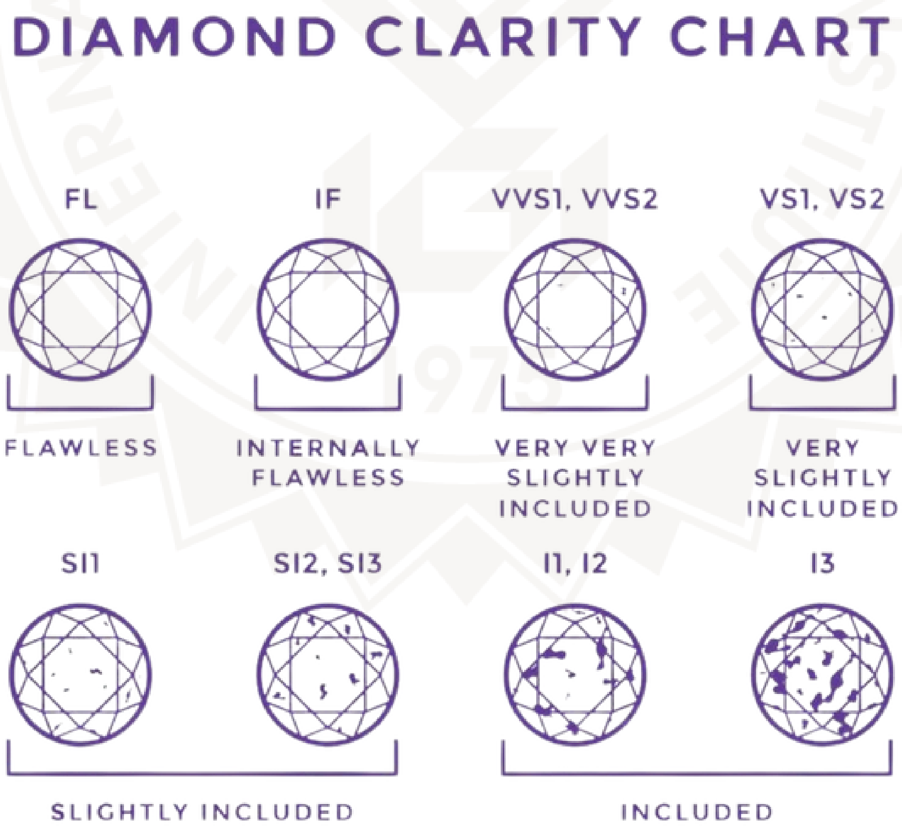
C2 — COLOR GRADES (D → Z Scale — D is best, Z is most tinted)

D E F	COLORLESS	LGD advantage: D–F grades at a fraction of natural diamond prices.	RECOMMENDED
G H I J	NEAR COLORLESS	Near-colorless appearance with excellent value.	RECOMMENDED
K L M	SLIGHTLY TINTED	Faint yellow. Visible face-up. Works in yellow gold settings.	
N O P Q R	VERY LIGHT	Visible tint. Significantly affects appearance and value.	
S T U V W–Z	LIGHT YELLOW	Obvious color. Not standard for white diamond jewelry.	



C3 — CLARITY GRADES (FL = Flawless best → I3 = inclusions visible)

FL / IF	Flawless / Internally Flawless	Extremely rare. No inclusions under 10x magnification.	
VVS1 / VVS2	Very Very Slightly Included	Minor inclusions. Eye-clean. Best value for quality.	SWEET SPOT
VS1 / VS2	Very Slightly Included	Minor inclusions. Eye-clean. Best value for quality.	SWEET SPOT



C4 — CARAT WEIGHT QUICK REFERENCE

Carat Facts:

1 Carat = 0.2 Grams | 1 Carat = 100 Points | 1 Carat = 100 Cents | 1 Carat = 4 Grains

Round Brilliant Diameter Guide:

0.25ct = 4.1mm | 0.50ct = 5.0mm | 0.75ct = 5.7mm | 1.00ct = 6.5mm | 1.50ct = 7.3mm | 2.00ct = 8.0mm | 3.00ct = 9.1mm

PROPERTY	LAB GROWN DIAMOND	NATURAL DIAMOND	SIMULANT (CZ/Moissanite)
Composition	100% Carbon	100% Carbon	ZrO_2/SiC
Hardness	10/10	10/10	8.5–9.25
Refractive Index	2.42	2.42	2.15/2.65
IGI Certified	YES ✓	YES ✓	NO ✗
Real Diamond?	YES ✓	YES ✓	NOT A DIAMOND ✗
Origin	Laboratory	Underground	Synthetic simulant

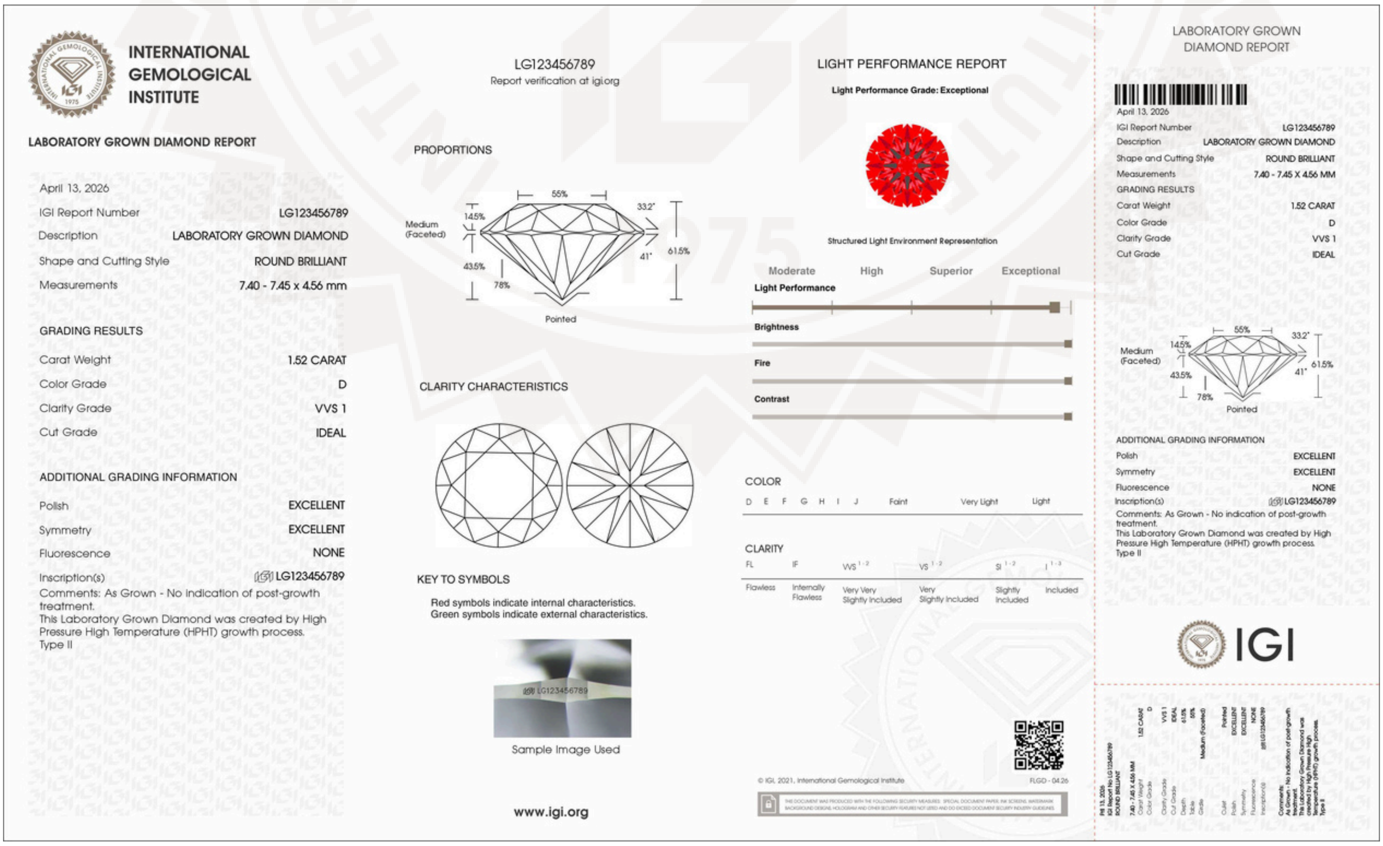
Note : Moissanite exhibits double refraction, whereas diamonds are singly refractive.

Lab-grown diamonds allow customers to maximize size and quality within budget

C5 — READING THE IGI CERTIFICATE — YOUR POWER MOVE AT THE COUNTER

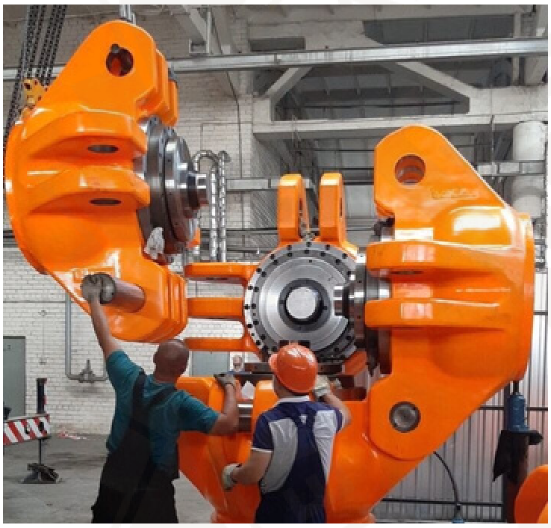
POWER MOVE: Never wait for the customer to ask. Hand the certificate FIRST.

STEP 1 **Report Number**	***"You can verify this on igi.org right now on your phone — instantly."***
STEP 2 **Shape & Cut Style**	***"Round Brilliant — Excellent cut. This is what gives it the sparkle."***
STEP 3 **Color & Clarity**	***"Color E — near colorless. Clarity VS1 — completely eye-clean. Independently certified."***
STEP 4 Carat Weight	***Report number is typically laser-inscribed on the girdle"***
STEP 5 QR Code	***"Scan this — your diamond's full report on your phone. Verified forever at igi.org."***


INTERNATIONAL GEMOLOGICAL INSTITUTE
LABORATORY GROWN DIAMOND REPORT
April 13, 2026
IGI Report Number LG123456789
Description LABORATORY GROWN DIAMOND
Shape and Cutting Style ROUND BRILLIANT
Measurements 7.40 - 7.45 x 4.56 mm
GRADING RESULTS
Carat Weight 1.52 CARAT
Color Grade D
Clarity Grade VVS 1
Cut Grade IDEAL
ADDITIONAL GRADING INFORMATION
Polish EXCELLENT
Symmetry EXCELLENT
Fluorescence NONE
Inscription(s) IGI LG123456789
Comments: As Grown - No indication of post-growth treatment.
This Laboratory Grown Diamond was created by High Pressure High Temperature (HPHT) growth process.
Type II
LG123456789
Report verification at igi.org
PROPORTIONS
CLARITY CHARACTERISTICS
KEY TO SYMBOLS
Red symbols indicate internal characteristics.
Green symbols indicate external characteristics.
Sample Image Used
www.igi.org
LIGHT PERFORMANCE REPORT
Light Performance Grade: Exceptional
Structured Light Environment Representation
Moderate High Superior Exceptional
Light Performance
Brightness
Fire
Contrast
COLOR
CLARITY
LABORATORY GROWN DIAMOND REPORT

LGD GROWTH METHODS

HPHT	CVD
High Pressure High Temperature	Chemical Vapor Deposition
① Carbon seed crystal placed in a press	① Carbon-rich gas introduced into chamber
② Exposed to 1,500°C + 1.5 million PSI	② Microwave energy activates the gas
③ Replicates extreme underground conditions	③ Carbon layers build atom by atom
④ Carbon crystallises into diamond structure	④ Diamond grows layer by layer on seed



1955

The first lab-grown diamond is created using the HPHt method

1971

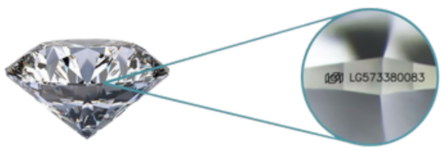
The first gem-quality lab-grown diamond is made

1980s

The CVD method is further developed, leading to the production of gem-quality LGDs

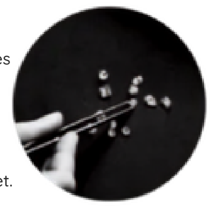
2026

IGI is a global leader in grading lab-grown diamonds.



2018

The FTC recognizes lab-grown diamonds as real diamonds, solidifying their place in the market.



Customer Questions & Winning Answers

	Associate Answer
Is Lab Grown Real?	Yes. Same chemical, physical and optical properties as a natural diamond.
Why is it cheaper?	Because it's grown in a laboratory instead of mined from the earth.
Will it sparkle like a natural diamond?	Yes. Both have the same refractive index of 2.42 and identical brilliance.
Is it certified?	Yes. IGI independently grades both natural and lab-grown diamonds.
Will it pass a diamond tester?	Yes. Standard diamond testers identify it as diamond.

Fluorescence Selling Guide

Fluorescence	Meaning	Selling Message
None	No glow under UV	Most preferred
Faint	Very slight glow	No visible impact
Medium	Moderate UV reaction	Usually not visible
Strong	Strong UV reaction	Can sometimes improve appearance

Associate Script:
"Fluorescence is not a defect. It is simply a diamond's reaction to ultraviolet light."

Diamond vs Moissanite Quick Comparison

Feature	Diamond	Moissanite
Hardness	10	9.25
Refractive Index	2.42	2.65
Double Refraction	No	Yes
Fire	Balanced	Excessive
Diamond Tester	Passes	Often Passes
Real Diamond	Yes	No

Key Retail Line:
"Moissanite is an excellent simulant, but it is not a diamond."

Natural vs Lab-Grown Diamond Comparison

Parameter	Natural	Lab-Grown
Composition	Carbon	Carbon
Hardness	10	10
Brilliance	Same	Same
Certification	IGI	IGI
Origin	Earth	Laboratory

Sales Line
"Origin is different. The diamond is the same."

Objection Handling Section

"Lab diamonds have no resale."

Suggested response:

Jewellery is primarily an emotional and wearable asset. Most customers choose LGDs for better size and quality within the same budget.

"Natural diamonds are rarer."

Suggested response:

Natural diamonds are rarer, while lab-grown diamonds offer better value and larger sizes.

"Will it become yellow?"

Suggested response:

No. A certified lab-grown diamond remains a diamond permanently.

Retail Associate Closing Scripts

Budget Customer

"Would you prefer a larger diamond or a higher grade within the same budget?"

Solitaire Customer

"For solitaires, I recommend Excellent Cut first because sparkle is what people notice immediately."

Upgrade Customer

"With a lab-grown diamond, you can often increase size without increasing your budget."

Objection Handling Section

"Lab diamonds have no resale."

Suggested response:

Jewellery is primarily an emotional and wearable asset. Most customers choose LGDs for better size and quality within the same budget.

"Natural diamonds are rarer."

Suggested response:

Natural diamonds are rarer, while lab-grown diamonds offer better value and larger sizes.

"Will it become yellow?"

Suggested response:

No. A certified lab-grown diamond remains a diamond permanently.

Retail Associate Closing Scripts

Budget Customer

"Would you prefer a larger diamond or a higher grade within the same budget?"

Solitaire Customer

"For solitaires, I recommend Excellent Cut first because sparkle is what people notice immediately."

Upgrade Customer

"With a lab-grown diamond, you can often increase size without increasing your budget."

"10 Golden Rules of Selling Diamond Jewelry"

1. **Show certificate first.**
2. **Sell Cut before Carat.**
3. **Never use technical jargon first.**
4. **Let customer compare visually.**
5. **Ask open-ended questions.**
6. **Explain value, not price.**
7. **Demonstrate sparkle under light.**
8. **Verify certification online.**
9. **Handle objections calmly.**
10. **Close with confidence.**

Bonus Section

Why Is Your Diamond More Expensive Than Online?

Customer-Friendly Answer

> "When comparing diamonds, it's important to compare the complete value, not just the price. Factors such as certification, cut quality, craftsmanship, setting quality, after-sales service, warranty, exchange policies, and the trust of the retailer all contribute to the final price."

Short Sales Version

> "A diamond isn't just a carat weight and certificate. The quality of the cut, jewellery manufacturing, service support, and brand assurance all affect value."

Detailed Response

> "Online listings often show only the stone price. Our pricing includes expert selection, quality checks, professional setting, certification verification, service support, and the confidence of seeing the diamond before purchasing."

If Customer Shows an Online Price

> "Let's compare the exact specifications—carat, color, clarity, cut grade, certification, fluorescence, and the jewellery setting. Even small differences can significantly affect price."

Why Buy a Lab-Grown Diamond Over a Natural Diamond?

Customer-Friendly Answer

> "Both natural and lab-grown diamonds are real diamonds with the same beauty, sparkle, hardness, and certification standards. The main difference is origin. Lab-grown diamonds offer significantly larger size and higher quality for the same budget."

Short Sales Version

> "If maximizing size and quality within your budget is important, a lab-grown diamond offers exceptional value."

Example

> "For the same budget, a customer may choose a 1.00 ct natural diamond or a significantly larger lab-grown diamond with similar color and clarity."

When to Recommend LGD

- Customer wants a bigger diamond.
- Customer wants higher color/clarity.
- Customer has a fixed budget.
- Customer is comparing value options.

Never Say

❌ "Online diamonds are fake."

❌ "Their certificates are not genuine."

❌ "Our diamonds are better."

Instead Say

✅ "Let's compare the specifications side by side so you can make an informed decision."

One-Line Closing Script

> "Our goal is not to sell the cheapest diamond—it's to help you choose the right diamond with complete confidence."

KEY TERMS GLOSSARY — SPEAK THE LANGUAGE OF DIAMONDS

Term	Description
Brilliance	White light reflected from the interior and surface of a polished diamond.
Fire	Dispersion of white light into spectral rainbow colors.
Scintillation	The sparkle — pattern of light and dark when the diamond or observer moves.
Inclusion	Internal characteristic formed during diamond growth.
Blemish	External surface characteristic — such as a scratch or abrasion.
Eye-Clean	No inclusions visible to the unaided naked eye.
Girdle	The widest part of the diamond where the laser inscription sits.
Table	The flat top facet — the largest facet on the crown.
Culet	The bottom point — should be pointed or very small.
Pavilion	The lower portion — controls upward light reflection.
Crown	The upper portion — captures incoming light.
Fluorescence	Glow under UV light — None, Faint, Medium, or Strong.
Simulant	Resembles a diamond but is NOT a diamond — like CZ or Moissanite.
HPHT	High Pressure High Temperature growth method.
CVD	Chemical Vapor Deposition growth method.
LGD	Lab Grown Diamond — a real diamond, grown in a laboratory.